

Muhammad Abdullah

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Red team and offensive security practitioner with hands-on experience in malware development, adversary simulation, and endpoint security evasion research. Strong focus on Windows internals, custom payload execution, process injection techniques, and evaluating modern defensive controls through realistic attack tradecraft. Certified eJPTv2 with proven national and international CTF competition record. Seeking roles in penetration testing, red team operations, security quality assurance, and vulnerability assessment.

EDUCATION

Ghulam Ishaq Khan Institute of Engineering Sciences and Technology

Swabi, Pakistan

B.Sc. in Cyber Security — GPA: 3.39 / 4.00

Sep 2022 – Expected Jun 2026

- Relevant Coursework: Network Security, Cryptography, Malware Analysis, Operating Systems, Computer Architecture, Database Systems, Software Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

eLearnSecurity Junior Penetration Tester (eJPTv2) – INE Security

Actively Pursuing: eLearnSecurity Web Penetration Tester (eWPT)

EXPERIENCE

Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing Intern

Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

National Cyber Emergency Response Team (PKCERT)

Islamabad, Pakistan

- Conducted authorized penetration testing against Windows Active Directory environments and internal web applications, identifying critical misconfigurations and privilege escalation paths.
- Developed and tested custom payloads to evaluate antivirus (AV) and endpoint detection and response (EDR) effectiveness, documenting evasion results for internal security teams.
- Simulated attacker lateral movement techniques (e.g., Pass-the-Hash, token impersonation) to assess organizational exposure and network segmentation controls.
- Produced structured technical reports translating offensive findings into prioritized remediation actions for both technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Capture The Flag (CTF) Competitor

2023 – Present

National and International Cybersecurity Competitions

- Competed in Ignite National Cybersecurity Hackathon, Pakistan Cybersecurity Challenge (PCC) by NCCS, Hack The Box, and BlackHat MEA Online Qualifier (ranked 185th of 1,500 teams globally).
- Solved challenges across penetration testing, reverse engineering, binary exploitation, web application security, and cryptography, reinforcing practical offensive skill sets.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Penetration Testing: Vulnerability Assessment, Web Application Testing (OWASP Top 10), Internal/External Network Pentesting, Active Directory Attacks

Red Team Operations: Adversary Simulation, Threat Emulation, C2 Infrastructure (Havoc, Sliver), Lateral Movement, Post-Exploitation, MITRE ATT&CK

Malware Development & Evasion: Custom Payload Development, Process Injection, Reflective DLL Loading, Fileless Execution, AV/EDR Bypass, AMSI Bypass

Exploitation: Windows/Linux Privilege Escalation, Binary Exploitation, Reverse Engineering, CVE Research

Programming/Scripting: Python, C, C++, PowerShell, Bash, Go, Rust, Nim, Dart

Tools & Platforms: Kali Linux, Metasploit Framework, Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Ghidra, Binwalk, Git, Arduino IDE

Security Concepts: Windows Internals, API Hooking, Detection Engineering, Threat Modeling, OSINT, MITRE ATT&CK Framework

Reporting & QA: Technical Report Writing, Vulnerability Triage, Risk Assessment, Remediation Validation, Stakeholder Communication

THE INSIDE JOB: Stealthy Hardware-Assisted Malware | *Final Year Project (FYP)*

2024 – 2026

- Designed a red team simulation framework focused on covert payload execution and endpoint security evasion, mapping attack techniques to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Implemented hardware-based payload delivery using an Arduino Pro Micro emulating a USB HID device (Rubber Ducky), successfully bypassing Mark-of-the-Web (MOTW) restrictions with zero artifacts written to disk.
- Engineered in-memory execution techniques including process injection (DLL injection, reflective loading) and staged payloads to achieve fileless execution and evade modern AV/EDR solutions.
- Evaluated detection blind spots in modern endpoint defenses and produced structured reports with recommended detection engineering countermeasures.
- *Technologies: C/C++, Python, Golang, FastAPI, Cloudflare, Arduino, Windows API, MITRE ATT&CK*

IoT Firmware Security Assessment | *Embedded Linux Security Research*

- Performed static and dynamic analysis of embedded Linux firmware images using binwalk, Ghidra, and custom scripts to extract and inspect filesystem contents.
- Identified insecure services, hardcoded credentials, command injection points, and authentication misconfigurations; documented findings with severity ratings and remediation guidance.

Assembly Language Simulator | *github.com/abdullahimtiazvousafzai*

- Built a GUI-based interpreter and simulator for a custom assembly language in Python/Tkinter, enabling step-by-step execution and register inspection – demonstrating low-level systems knowledge relevant to binary analysis and reverse engineering.